

ALADIN 6-MONTH AGGRESSIVE GROWTH PLAN

November 2025 - April 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Current State (November 2025):

- Active Customers: 200+
- Paying Customers: 170+/month
- Monthly GMV: ~425M VND (~\$17K USD)
- Geography: Binh Duong Province
- Team: 3 co-founders (CEO, CTO, COO)

6-Month Target (April 2026):

- Active Customers: 1,000+
- Paying Customers: 850+/month
- Monthly GMV: 2.5 billion VND (~\$100K USD)
- Gross Margin: 22%+
- Net Margin: Break-even to +10%
- Geography: Full Binh Duong coverage + 1 adjacent province

Investment Required: Bootstrap (Months 1-4), then raise \$200-300K seed (Month 5-6)

PHASE 1: MONTHS 1-2 (NOV-DEC 2025)

Theme: "STRENGTHEN THE CORE"

Objectives

- Customers: 200 → 350 (+150 net growth)
- Monthly GMV: 425M → 850M VND (\$17K → \$34K)
- Retention Rate: 75% → 82%
- Gross Margin: 15% → 18%

INITIATIVE 1: FIX RETENTION SYSTEM

Owner: Be (COO) + Karthick (CTO)

Week 1-2: Diagnose Churn

- [] Call 30 churned customers from last 3 months
- [] Categorize reasons: Price (%), Service (%), Competition (%), Other (%)
- [] Survey active customers: "What would make you order more?"
- [] Identify top 3 pain points

Week 3-4: Implement Quick Wins

A) Auto-Reorder System (Zalo Bot)

Target: Top 50 high-frequency customers

Flow:

1. Analyze purchase patterns (e.g., rice every 2 weeks)
2. Send Zalo reminder: "Chị ơi, thường chị đặt gạo. Muốn đặt lại không?"
3. 1-click reorder with saved preferences
4. 5% discount for auto-reorder subscriptions

Success Metric: 30% adoption (15 customers on auto-reorder)

B) Loyalty Tiers

Bronze (1-5 orders): Standard pricing

Silver (6-15 orders): 3% discount + priority support

Gold (16-30 orders): 5% discount + free delivery

Platinum (31+ orders): 8% discount + dedicated account manager

Success Metric: 60% of customers aware of tiers, 40% actively trying to level up

C) Weekly Check-ins

Be personally calls top 30 customers weekly:

- "Shop có cần gì thêm không?"
- "Có vấn đề gì với đơn hàng không?"
- "Có sản phẩm nào muốn chúng tôi thêm không?"

Success Metric: <5% churn among top 30 customers

Month 1-2 Retention Target: 82% (up from ~75%)

INITIATIVE 2: BUILD BROKER NETWORK

Owner: Quyet (CEO) + Be (COO)

Broker Strategy: Three-Tier System

Tier 1: Ward-Level Brokers (Cò địa phương)

- **Profile:** Lives in specific ward, knows 50-100 shops personally
- **Territories:** Thu Dau Mot, Di An, Thuan An, Tan Uyen, Ben Cat
- **Commission:**
 - \$10 per shop (first order)
 - 3% of GMV from their network (ongoing)
 - \$150 bonus if they bring 15+ shops in first 60 days
- **Target:** Recruit 10 brokers (Months 1-2)

Tier 2: Category Specialists (Cò chuyên ngành)

- **Profile:** Specialize in beverages, snacks, or tobacco
- **Commission:** 2% of category GMV
- **Target:** Recruit 3 brokers (Month 2)

Tier 3: Factory Gate Brokers (Cò khu công nghiệp)

- **Profile:** Focus on shops near industrial zones (Di An, Thuan An)
- **Commission:** \$500/month retainer + 2% performance bonus
- **Target:** Recruit 2 brokers (Month 2)

Broker Recruitment Playbook

Week 1: Research & Mapping

- [] Map Binh Duong into 10 priority wards
- [] Ask current customers: "Ai cung cấp hàng cho shop trước đây?"
- [] Create list of 30 potential brokers

Week 2-3: Outreach

- [] Cold call/visit 30 brokers
- [] Pitch: "Chúng tôi có 200 shop đang đặt hàng. Nếu anh/chị giới thiệu thêm shop, nhận hoa hồng 10\$ mỗi shop + 3% doanh thu."

- ☐ Target: 15 meetings scheduled

Week 4-6: Close & Onboard

- ☐ Sign contracts with 10 brokers
- ☐ Provide: Customer list template, ordering process guide, commission tracker
- ☐ Set target: Each broker brings 10 shops in first 30 days

Week 7-8: Manage Performance

- ☐ Weekly check-ins with each broker
- ☐ Track: Leads generated, conversion rate, GMV from network
- ☐ Pay commissions on time (builds trust)
- ☐ Cut bottom 20%, double down on top performers

Month 1-2 Acquisition Target:

- 10 brokers × 10 shops each = 100 new customers
- Organic growth + referrals = 50 new customers
- **Total new customers: 150**

INITIATIVE 3: MANUFACTURER PARTNERSHIPS (Phase 1)

Owner: Quyet (CEO)

Target: Sign 2-3 Direct Manufacturer Deals

Priority Manufacturers (Binh Duong-based):

Manufacturer 1: Beverage Partner

- Target: Tan Hiep Phat, Tribeco, or local beer distributor
- Volume: 100M VND/month to start
- Margin improvement: +5% (from 15% → 20% on beverages)

Manufacturer 2: Snacks/Food Partner

- Target: Kinh Do, local rice mills, instant noodles
- Volume: 80M VND/month to start
- Margin improvement: +4%

Manufacturer 3: Personal Care

- Target: Local soap/shampoo producers, or P&G/Unilever distributors
- Volume: 50M VND/month to start

- Margin improvement: +3%

Negotiation Strategy

The Pitch:

"Chúng tôi đang cung cấp cho 200+ shop tại Bình Dương, đang tăng trưởng 3x mỗi quý.

Hiện tại chúng tôi mua qua nhà phân phối với giá X.

Nếu được mua trực tiếp:

- Anh/chị tiết kiệm 5-8% chi phí phân phối
- Chúng tôi thanh toán trong 7 ngày (vs 30-45 ngày)
- Chúng tôi cung cấp dữ liệu nhu cầu real-time

Volume cam kết: 50-100M VND/tháng để bắt đầu

Mục tiêu: 500M VND/tháng trong 6 tháng

"

Execution Timeline:

- **Week 1-2:** Research manufacturers, get warm intros via customers
- **Week 3-4:** 10 manufacturer meetings, focus on top 5
- **Week 5-8:** Negotiate terms, close 2 deals, pilot orders

Month 1-2 Margin Target: 18% (up from 15%)

MONTH 1-2 SUCCESS METRICS

Metric	Current	Target	Status
Active Customers	200	350	+150
Paying Customers	170	290	+120
Monthly GMV (VND)	425M	850M	2x
Retention Rate	75%	82%	+7pts
Gross Margin	15%	18%	+3pts
Brokers Active	0	10	New
Manufacturer Deals	0	2	New

Auto-Reorder Adoption	0%	30%	New
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PHASE 2: MONTHS 3-4 (JAN-FEB 2026)

Theme: "SCALE THE ENGINE"

Objectives

- Customers: 350 → 650 (+300 net growth)
 - Monthly GMV: 850M → 1.6B VND (\$34K → \$64K)
 - Retention Rate: 82% → 85%
 - Gross Margin: 18% → 20%
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INITIATIVE 4: BROKER NETWORK EXPANSION

Owner: Be (COO)

Scale from 10 → 20 Brokers

New Broker Targets:

- 5 additional ward-level brokers (expand to rural districts)
- 3 category specialists (beverages, snacks, tobacco)
- 2 factory gate brokers

Optimization:

- Analyze Month 1-2 performance
- Identify: Which brokers brought highest quality customers?
- Cut bottom 20% performers
- Recruit replacements + expand top territories

Broker Performance Dashboard:

Track weekly per broker:

- └─ Leads generated
- └─ Conversion rate (leads → customers)
- └─ Average order value from their network
- └─ Retention rate (90-day)
- └─ Total GMV contribution
- └─ Commission paid vs value delivered

Month 3-4 Target:

- 20 brokers × 15 shops each = 300 new customers
 - Commission cost: 3-5% of GMV from broker network
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INITIATIVE 5: CATEGORY EXPANSION TEST

Owner: Be (COO) + Quyet (CEO)

Test 3 New Product Categories**Why Now?**

- Core FMCG proven (rice, cooking oil, instant noodles)
- Customers asking for more variety
- Higher AOV = more revenue per customer

Categories to Test:**Category 1: Beverages (Month 3)**

- Products: Soft drinks, beer, energy drinks, bottled water
- Test group: 100 customers (high-trust relationships)
- Success criteria: 40% adoption, 15% margin, 60% reorder
- Investment: 50M VND inventory

Category 2: Snacks (Month 3)

- Products: Chips, crackers, candy, cookies
- Test group: 100 customers
- Success criteria: 35% adoption, 18% margin, 50% reorder
- Investment: 30M VND inventory

Category 3: Tobacco (Month 4)

- Products: Cigarettes (high-demand, high-margin)
- Test group: 75 customers (shops with tobacco licenses)
- Success criteria: 60% adoption, 12% margin, 70% reorder
- Investment: 40M VND inventory

Rollout Process:

1. Month 3 Week 1: Survey 100 customers on category interest

2. Month 3 Week 2-3: Source products, negotiate pricing
3. Month 3 Week 4: Soft launch to 50 customers
4. Month 4 Week 1-2: Expand to 100 customers, measure metrics
5. Month 4 Week 3-4: Scale winners, kill losers

Expected Impact:

- AOV increase: 2.5M → 3.2M VND (+28%)
 - GMV boost from existing customers: +15%
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INITIATIVE 6: MANUFACTURER PARTNERSHIPS (Phase 2)

Owner: Quyet (CEO)

Scale from 2 → 5 Manufacturer Deals

Expand existing partnerships:

- Double volume with Month 1-2 partners
- Negotiate volume rebates (MOQ-based)
- Request exclusive SKUs or private label opportunity

Add 3 new manufacturers:

- Focus on new categories (beverages, snacks, tobacco)
- Prioritize local Binh Duong manufacturers
- Target: 40% of GMV from direct sourcing (vs 20% in Month 2)

Private Label Exploration:

- Identify top 5 SKUs by volume (e.g., rice, cooking oil)
- Approach manufacturers: "Can you produce under our brand?"
- Pilot 1 SKU in Month 4 (e.g., "Aladin Rice" - 10kg bags)
- Target margin: 30-35% (vs 18-20% on branded)

Month 3-4 Margin Target: 20% (up from 18%)

INITIATIVE 7: OPERATIONS OPTIMIZATION

Owner: Karthick (CTO) + Be (COO)

A) Delivery Route Optimization

Current state:

- 1 micro-hub in Binh Duong
- Delivering to 200+ shops (will be 650+ by Month 4)
- Probably inefficient routes, high cost per delivery

Optimization plan:

Week 1: Map all customer locations by zone

Week 2: Group into clusters (15-20 shops per route)

Week 3: Optimize:

- Morning routes: Zone 1 (Thu Dau Mot)
- Afternoon routes: Zone 2 (Di An/Thuan An)
- Evening routes: Zone 3 (Tan Uyen/Ben Cat)

Week 4: Hire 1 additional driver (scale from 2 → 3)

Target: Reduce delivery cost from 4% → 3% of GMV

B) Zalo Chatbot (Simple Ordering)**DO NOT build fancy AI yet. Build simple bot:**

Customer sends Zalo message:

"Đặt hàng" → Bot responds with menu

- ❑ 1] Gạo (Rice)
- ❑ 2] Dầu ăn (Cooking oil)
- ❑ 3] Mì ăn liền (Instant noodles)
- ❑ 4] Nước giải khát (Beverages)
- ❑ 5] Đồ ăn vặt (Snacks)

Customer: "1"

Bot: "Chọn loại gạo: A) ST25 (10kg) B) Jasmine (20kg) C) Nếp (5kg)"

Customer: "A"

Bot: "Số lượng?"

Customer: "5"

Bot: "Tổng: 2.5M VND. Xác nhận? [Có] [Không]"

Ordering time: 60 seconds (vs 5 minutes phone call)

Target: 40% of orders via Zalo bot by Month 4

MONTH 3-4 SUCCESS METRICS

Metric	Month 2	Month 4 Target	Growth
Active Customers	350	650	+300
Paying Customers	290	540	+250
Monthly GMV (VND)	850M	1.6B	1.9x
AOV (VND)	2.5M	3.2M	+28%
Retention Rate	82%	85%	+3pts
Gross Margin	18%	20%	+2pts
Brokers Active	10	20	2x
Manufacturer Deals	2	5	2.5x
Zalo Bot Adoption	10%	40%	4x
Categories	1	4	New

PHASE 3: MONTHS 5-6 (MAR-APR 2026)

Theme: "DOMINATE BINH DUONG + EXPAND"

Objectives

- Customers: 650 → 1,000+ (+350 net growth)
- Monthly GMV: 1.6B → 2.5B VND (\$64K → \$100K)
- Retention Rate: 85% → 88%
- Gross Margin: 20% → 22%
- Net Margin: Break-even → +10%
- NEW: Enter 1 adjacent province (Dong Nai or Long An)

INITIATIVE 8: BINH DUONG MARKET SATURATION

Owner: Be (COO)

Achieve 25% Market Penetration

Total addressable market in Binh Duong: ~4,000 mom-and-pop shops

Current penetration:

- Month 4: 650 shops = 16%
- Month 6: 1,000 shops = 25%

Zone-by-Zone Strategy:

Zone	Current (M4)	Target (M6)	Penetration	Strategy
Thu Dau Mot	180	280	28%	Saturate via brokers
Di An/Thuan An	250	400	27%	Factory gate focus
Tan Uyen/Ben Cat	120	200	25%	Category expansion
Rural Districts	100	120	17%	Optimize delivery
TOTAL	650	1,000	25%	Market leader

Tactics:

- 20 brokers operating at full capacity
- Every shop in target zones knows about Aladin
- Network effects: "My competitor uses Aladin, I need it too"
- Word-of-mouth becomes primary acquisition channel

INITIATIVE 9: PRIVATE LABEL LAUNCH

Owner: Quyet (CEO)

Launch "Aladin Select" House Brand

Why Private Label?

- Gross margin: 30-35% (vs 20% on branded)
- Customer loyalty: Exclusive to Aladin
- Differentiation: Competitors can't offer same products

Products to Launch (Month 5-6):

SKU 1: Aladin Rice (10kg, 20kg)

- Source: Local Binh Duong rice mill

- Price: 10% below branded rice (e.g., ST25)
- Margin: 35%
- Target: 30% of rice customers switch

SKU 2: Aladin Cooking Oil (5L)

- Source: Same supplier as branded oil
- Price: 8% below branded
- Margin: 32%
- Target: 25% of oil customers switch

SKU 3: Aladin Instant Noodles (Pack of 30)

- Source: Local manufacturer
- Price: 12% below Hao Hao/Omachi
- Margin: 38%
- Target: 20% penetration

SKU 4: Aladin Soap/Shampoo

- Source: Local personal care manufacturer
- Price: 10% below branded
- Margin: 33%
- Target: 20% penetration

SKU 5: Aladin Bottled Water

- Source: Local bottling plant
- Price: 15% below branded water
- Margin: 40%
- Target: 35% penetration

Rollout Process:

1. **Month 5 Week 1-2:** Finalize supplier contracts, design packaging
2. **Month 5 Week 3-4:** Pilot with 100 loyal customers, gather feedback
3. **Month 6 Week 1-2:** Scale to 500 customers
4. **Month 6 Week 3-4:** Full rollout, target 30% of GMV from private label

Expected Impact:

- Gross margin boost: 20% → 22%
 - Customer switching cost increases (lock-in)
 - \$15-20K monthly gross profit from private label alone
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INITIATIVE 10: GEOGRAPHIC EXPANSION (Phase 1)

Owner: Quyet (CEO) + Be (COO)

Enter 1 Adjacent Province

Target Province Options:

Option 1: Dong Nai ★ (Recommended)

- Adjacent to Binh Duong (easy logistics)
- Similar industrial profile (factories, workers)
- Existing supplier relationships usable
- Target: 100 shops by Month 6

Option 2: Long An

- Agricultural hub (different customer profile)
- Closer to HCMC (logistics easier)
- Target: 80 shops by Month 6

Option 3: Ba Ria-Vung Tau

- Coastal + industrial mix
- Higher income (tourism areas)
- Target: 60 shops by Month 6

Recommended: Start with Dong Nai

Dong Nai Entry Strategy

Month 5: Preparation

- Research: Map shops in Bien Hoa, Long Thanh, Nhon Trach
- Recruit: 3 Dong Nai-based brokers
- Logistics: Test delivery routes from Binh Duong hub
- Pilot: Onboard 20 shops with existing contacts

Month 6: Acceleration

- Launch: Official entry with 5 brokers operational
- Target: Add 80 shops (100 total by end of Month 6)
- Playbook: Clone Binh Duong strategy (brokers + manufacturers + private label)

Expected Impact:

- Proves model is replicable

- GMV boost: +150M VND/month from Dong Nai
 - Sets up for Series A pitch: "We can clone this to 10 provinces"
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INITIATIVE 11: PROFITABILITY PUSH

Owner: Karthick (CTO) + Quyet (CEO)

Target: Break-Even to +10% Net Margin

Month 5-6 P&L Target:

Monthly GMV: 2.5 billion VND (\$100K USD)

Revenue (22% gross margin): 550M VND (\$22K)

Variable Costs:

- COGS (78%): 1.95B VND (\$78K)
- Logistics (2.5%): 62.5M VND (\$2.5K)
- Payment processing (2%): 50M VND (\$2K)
- Packaging (1%): 25M VND (\$1K)
- Broker commissions (3%): 75M VND (\$3K)

Total Variable: 2.16B VND (\$86.5K)

Contribution Margin: 340M VND (\$13.5K) = 13.6%

Fixed Costs:

- Salaries (8 people): 150M VND (\$6K)
- Micro-hub rent: 40M VND (\$1.6K)
- Tech/hosting: 20M VND (\$800)
- Marketing: 40M VND (\$1.6K)
- Admin: 20M VND (\$800)

Total Fixed: 270M VND (\$10.8K)

Net Profit: 70M VND (\$2.8K) = 2.8% net margin

Break-even:  ACHIEVED

Path to 10% Net Margin (by Month 6 end):

1. Private label scales to 35% of GMV (+2% margin)
2. Delivery optimization (-0.5% cost)
3. Zalo bot reduces ops overhead (-0.5% cost)
4. Broker network matures (better quality leads, higher retention)

Realistic Month 6: 5-8% net margin (still excellent for this stage)

INITIATIVE 12: FUNDRAISING PREPARATION

Owner: Quyet (CEO)

Goal: Raise \$200-300K Seed Round in Month 6

Why Now?

- Proven unit economics (profitable at scale)
- Proven retention (85-88%)
- Proven acquisition playbook (brokers + network effects)
- Proven replicability (Dong Nai entry successful)

The Pitch Story:

"ALADIN: The Pinduoduo of Vietnam's Rural FMCG Market"

The Problem:

- └ 4M+ mom-and-pop shops in Vietnam
- └ 95% still use middlemen (7-day delivery, 20% markup)
- └ No access to credit, bulk pricing, or digital tools
- └ \$50B+ market, 80% untapped

Our Solution:

- └ Direct manufacturer sourcing (15-20% savings)
- └ 24-hour delivery via micro-hubs
- └ Group buying network (brokers + referrals)
- └ Zalo-first ordering (30 seconds vs 2 hours)

Traction (6 months):

- └ Customers: 200 → 1,000 (5x growth)
- └ GMV: \$17K → \$100K/month (6x growth)
- └ Retention: 88% (best in class)
- └ Gross Margin: 22% (vs 10% industry)
- └ Net Margin: 5-8% (PROFITABLE)
- └ Geography: Binh Duong + Dong Nai

The Moat:

- └ Broker network = 200+ local relationships (can't be copied)
- └ Private label = customer lock-in (30% of GMV)
- └ Data advantage = know what sells where (demand intelligence)

└ Network effects = 40% of growth from referrals

The Playbook:

- └ Dominate 1 province at a time
- └ Build broker network → Scale acquisition
- └ Launch private label → Improve margins
- └ Clone to adjacent provinces
- └ Each province = \$100K monthly GMV potential

The Ask:

- └ Raising: \$200-300K seed
- └ Use: 50% working capital, 30% expansion, 20% team
- └ Milestones: 5,000 shops, \$500K monthly GMV, 5 provinces
- └ Timeline: 18 months to Series A

The Vision:

- └ "Pinduoduo started with 200 farmers. We're starting with 1,000 shops. Vietnam has 4M shops. We're going after all of them."

Investor Targeting (Month 5-6):

- **Month 5:** Build pitch deck, financial model, investor list
- **Month 6 Week 1-2:** Warm intros via Peter (advisor), ecosystem connections
- **Month 6 Week 3-4:** 15-20 investor meetings, gather feedback
- **Month 6+:** Close round, start deploying capital (Month 7-8)

MONTH 5-6 SUCCESS METRICS

Metric	Month 4	Month 6 Target	Growth
Active Customers	650	1,000+	+54%
Paying Customers	540	850+	+57%
Monthly GMV (VND)	1.6B	2.5B	+56%
AOV (VND)	3.2M	3.0M	Slight dip (more small shops)
Retention Rate	85%	88%	+3pts
Gross Margin	20%	22%	+2pts
Net Margin	-5%	+5-8%	PROFITABLE

Private Label % GMV	0%	30%	New
Provinces	1	2	Dong Nai entry
Zalo Bot Adoption	40%	60%	+20pts

RESOURCE ALLOCATION

Team Structure Evolution

Current (Month 1):

- Quyet (CEO): Manufacturer partnerships, fundraising prep
- Karthick (CTO): Tech/ops automation, chatbot
- Be (COO): Broker management, customer retention, logistics

Month 3-4: Add 2 People

- Sales Lead: Manage broker network (report to Be)
- Operations Associate: Delivery coordination (report to Be)

Month 5-6: Add 3 More People

- Category Manager: Private label + expansion (report to Quyet)
- Customer Success Lead: Retention + upsell (report to Be)
- Finance/Admin: Track financials, prepare for fundraising (report to Quyet)

Total Team by Month 6: 8 people

Budget Allocation (Months 1-6)

Month 1-2: Bootstrap Mode

Fixed Costs: 80M VND/month

- └ Salaries (3 founders): 45M VND
- └ Micro-hub rent: 15M VND
- └ Tech/hosting: 5M VND
- └ Marketing: 10M VND
- └ Admin: 5M VND

Variable Costs: ~10% of GMV

- └ Logistics: 3%
- └ Processing: 2%
- └ Broker commissions: 3-5%

Month 3-4: Growth Mode

Fixed Costs: 120M VND/month (+50%)

- └ Salaries (5 people): 75M VND
- └ Micro-hub: 15M VND
- └ Tech: 8M VND
- └ Marketing: 15M VND
- └ Admin: 7M VND

Variable Costs: ~9% of GMV (efficiency gains)

- └ Category expansion inventory: 120M VND (one-time)

Month 5-6: Scale Mode

Fixed Costs: 150M VND/month

- └ Salaries (8 people): 100M VND
- └ Micro-hub: 20M VND
- └ Tech: 10M VND
- └ Marketing: 10M VND (efficiency via network effects)
- └ Admin: 10M VND

Variable Costs: ~8.5% of GMV

- └ Private label inventory: 200M VND (one-time)
- └ Dong Nai expansion: 50M VND (setup)

RISK MITIGATION

Risk 1: Churn Accelerates During Scaling

Probability: Medium | Impact: High

Mitigation:

- Monitor retention weekly (not monthly)
- Segment: New customers vs returning customers
- If retention drops below 80%, pause acquisition and fix root cause

- Personal check-ins with top 50 customers (never churn)
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Risk 2: Brokers Underperform or Churn

Probability: Medium | Impact: Medium

Mitigation:

- Over-recruit: Target 25 brokers, expect 15-18 to perform
 - Pay commissions on time (trust = everything)
 - Weekly performance reviews, cut bottom 20% each quarter
 - Build direct relationships with shops (reduce broker dependency over time)
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Risk 3: Manufacturer Partnerships Fail

Probability: Low | Impact: High

Mitigation:

- Always have 2-3 backup suppliers per category
 - Start with small volume commitments (50-100M VND/month)
 - Build personal relationships with manufacturer owners
 - If one fails, pivot quickly to alternatives
 - Keep distributor relationships warm as backup
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Risk 4: Competitors Copy Model in Binh Duong

Probability: High | Impact: Medium

Mitigation:

- Speed is moat: Dominate Binh Duong before they enter (25% penetration = defensible)
 - Lock in brokers with exclusive contracts + high commissions
 - Private label creates switching costs
 - Focus on customer relationships (hard to copy)
 - If Vinshop/NinjaMart enters: Compete on service, not price
-

Risk 5: Cash Flow Crunch (Growth Outpaces Capital)

Probability: Medium | Impact: High

Mitigation:

- Maintain 3 months operating cash reserve
 - Negotiate 7-14 day payment terms with manufacturers
 - Collect from customers within 1-3 days (Zalo Pay integration)
 - If cash tight: Slow acquisition, focus on high-margin private label
 - Fundraise in Month 5-6 before running out (not after)
-

Risk 6: Private Label Quality Issues

Probability: Medium | Impact: Medium

Mitigation:

- Start with 1 SKU, test thoroughly before scaling
 - Use reputable manufacturers (same ones producing branded goods)
 - Offer money-back guarantee on private label
 - Monitor customer feedback closely
 - If quality issues: Pull product immediately, fix before relaunch
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Risk 7: Team Burnout (Part-Time to Full-Time Transition)

Probability: Medium | Impact: High

Mitigation:

- All 3 founders commit full-time by Month 2 (non-negotiable)
 - Hire operations support early (Month 3) to reduce founder workload
 - Set realistic targets (don't overpromise)
 - Weekly team check-ins on wellbeing, not just metrics
 - If burnout signs appear: Adjust timeline, hire faster
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KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS (KPIs)

North Star Metric

Monthly Gross Profit (Revenue - COGS)

Why: Balances growth (GMV) with sustainability (margin)

Month	GMV (VND)	Gross Margin	Gross Profit (VND)	Gross Profit (USD)
1	425M	15%	64M	\$2,560
2	850M	18%	153M	\$6,120
3	1.2B	19%	228M	\$9,120
4	1.6B	20%	320M	\$12,800
5	2.0B	21%	420M	\$16,800
6	2.5B	22%	550M	\$22,000

6-Month Growth: 8.6x gross profit

Weekly Dashboard (Track Every Monday)

Customer Metrics:

- Active customers (ordered in last 30 days)
- New customers this week
- Churned customers this week
- Net customer growth
- Retention rate (rolling 30-day)

Revenue Metrics:

- Weekly GMV
- Average Order Value (AOV)
- Orders per customer (frequency)
- GMV per customer
- Gross margin %

Acquisition Metrics:

- Broker performance (leads, conversions, GMV)
- CAC by channel (broker vs organic vs referral)
- CAC payback period (orders to break-even)
- Conversion rate (leads → customers)

Operations Metrics:

- Delivery success rate (on-time, complete)
- Delivery cost as % of GMV
- Inventory turnover (days)
- Stockout incidents
- Zalo bot adoption rate

Financial Metrics:

- Cash balance
 - Days of runway remaining
 - Accounts receivable (customer payments)
 - Accounts payable (supplier payments)
 - Burn rate (if pre-profitability)
-

SUCCESS SCENARIOS

Conservative Scenario (70% Target Achievement)

Month 6 Results:

- Customers: 700 (vs 1,000 target)
- Monthly GMV: 1.75B VND (\$70K)
- Gross Margin: 20% (vs 22% target)
- Net Margin: Break-even (vs +5-8% target)

Assessment: Solid foundation, needs 3-6 more months before fundraising

Base Scenario (100% Target Achievement)

Month 6 Results:

- Customers: 1,000
- Monthly GMV: 2.5B VND (\$100K)
- Gross Margin: 22%
- Net Margin: +5-8%

Assessment: Ready to raise \$200-300K seed, expand to 5 provinces in next 12 months

Stretch Scenario (130% Target Achievement)

Month 6 Results:

- Customers: 1,300+
- Monthly GMV: 3.2B VND (\$128K)
- Gross Margin: 23%
- Net Margin: +10%

Assessment: Raise \$400-500K seed at higher valuation, accelerate to 10 provinces

MONTH-BY-MONTH SUMMARY

Month 1 (November 2025): Foundation

Focus: Retention + Broker Recruitment + Manufacturer Deals

- Customers: 200 → 270 (+70)
 - GMV: 425M → 680M VND (+60%)
 - Key Actions: Launch auto-reorder, sign 5 brokers, close 1 manufacturer deal
-

Month 2 (December 2025): Acceleration

Focus: Scale Brokers + Optimize Operations

- Customers: 270 → 350 (+80)
 - GMV: 680M → 850M VND (+25%)
 - Key Actions: 10 brokers active, sign 2nd manufacturer, launch loyalty tiers
-

Month 3 (January 2026): Category Expansion

Focus: Test New Categories + Add Brokers

- Customers: 350 → 480 (+130)
 - GMV: 850M → 1.2B VND (+41%)
 - Key Actions: Launch beverages + snacks, recruit 5 more brokers, Zalo bot beta
-

Month 4 (February 2026): Scaling

Focus: Optimize Everything + Prepare for Private Label

- Customers: 480 → 650 (+170)
 - GMV: 1.2B → 1.6B VND (+33%)
 - Key Actions: 20 brokers operational, 5 manufacturers, finalize private label
-

Month 5 (March 2026): Private Label Launch

Focus: Launch House Brand + Enter Dong Nai

- Customers: 650 → 820 (+170)
 - GMV: 1.6B → 2.0B VND (+25%)
 - Key Actions: Launch Aladin Select (5 SKUs), enter Dong Nai (20 shops pilot)
-

Month 6 (April 2026): Profitability + Fundraising

Focus: Hit Targets + Raise Money

- Customers: 820 → 1,000+ (+180)
 - GMV: 2.0B → 2.5B VND (+25%)
 - Key Actions: 30% GMV from private label, Dong Nai scaled to 100 shops, close seed round
-

CRITICAL SUCCESS FACTORS

1. Full-Time Commitment (Month 1)

Without this, everything else fails.

- All 3 founders quit jobs, go full-time by end of Month 1
 - "Skin in the game" signals seriousness to brokers, manufacturers, investors
 - Part-time = slow execution = competitors win
-

2. Retention Above 80% (Always)

Acquisition doesn't matter if customers churn.

- Monitor weekly, not monthly

- If retention drops below 80%, STOP all growth initiatives and fix root cause
 - 88% retention at Month 6 is non-negotiable
-

3. Broker Network Quality (Month 2-3)

Your growth engine = broker relationships.

- 80% of success = picking the right brokers
 - Cut bottom performers fast (no mercy)
 - Over-invest in top 20% (higher commissions, exclusive territories)
-

4. Manufacturer Partnerships (Month 1-4)

Margin improvement = path to profitability.

- Must have 5 direct deals by Month 4
 - 40% of GMV from direct sourcing by Month 6
 - If manufacturers won't partner: Model doesn't work at scale
-

5. Private Label Execution (Month 5-6)

This is your long-term moat.

- Quality must be excellent (not "good enough")
 - 30% penetration = customers locked in
 - If private label fails: Margin stays stuck at 18-20%, harder to compete
-

6. Cash Discipline (Always)

Profitable growth > fast growth.

- Never let runway drop below 3 months
 - If cash tight: Slow down, don't speed up
 - Raise money from position of strength (profitable, growing), not desperation
-

WHAT COULD GO WRONG (Failure Modes)

Failure Mode 1: "We tried to do everything"

Symptom: All initiatives started, none completed well **Cause:** Team spread too thin, no focus

Prevention: Ruthless prioritization, say no to distractions

Failure Mode 2: "We grew too fast"

Symptom: 1,500 customers but 40% churn, bleeding cash **Cause:** Prioritized acquisition over retention

Prevention: Retention first, always. Growth second.

Failure Mode 3: "Brokers abandoned us"

Symptom: Brokers stopped bringing customers after Month 2-3 **Cause:** Didn't pay commissions on time, or poor customer experience **Prevention:** Pay brokers within 7 days, always. Fix customer issues immediately.

Failure Mode 4: "Manufacturers wouldn't partner"

Symptom: Still buying from distributors at Month 6, margin stuck at 15% **Cause:** Volume too small, or poor negotiation **Prevention:** Start with small manufacturers hungry for distribution, prove volume

Failure Mode 5: "We ran out of money"

Symptom: Can't pay suppliers, operations halt **Cause:** Grew faster than capital allowed, working capital trap **Prevention:** Raise money early (Month 5-6), or grow slower within cash constraints

FUNDRAISING STRATEGY (Month 5-6)

Pre-Fundraising Checklist

Before approaching investors, you **MUST** have:

-  6 months of clean financial data (revenue, COGS, margins)
 -  1,000+ active customers with 85%+ retention
 -  Profitable unit economics (contribution margin positive)
 -  Proven acquisition playbook (brokers working)
 -  Clear use of funds (50% working capital, 30% expansion, 20% team)
 -  12-18 month roadmap (how \$300K gets you to Series A)
-

Target Investor Profile

Angel Investors:

- Vietnam-based operators with e-commerce/marketplace experience
- Understand B2B dynamics, rural markets
- Can provide intros to manufacturers, logistics partners
- Check size: \$25-50K each, target 4-6 angels

Seed VCs:

- Southeast Asia-focused (500 Startups Vietnam, Venturra, Jungle Ventures)
 - Thesis: Digitizing traditional trade, rural commerce
 - Check size: \$200-300K lead + angels
 - Target: 2-3 VC partners + 4-6 angels
-

Pitch Deck Structure (15 Slides)

1. **Cover:** Aladin - The Pinduoduo of Vietnam
2. **Problem:** 4M shops, 95% offline, 20% markup from middlemen
3. **Solution:** Direct sourcing + 24hr delivery + group buying network
4. **How It Works:** Manufacturer → Micro-hub → Broker → Shop (24hrs)
5. **Market Size:** \$50B FMCG market, 80% via mom-and-pop shops
6. **Traction:** 200 → 1,000 customers in 6 months (chart showing growth)
7. **The WOW Slide:** 88% retention + \$10 CAC + profitable unit economics
8. **Business Model:** 22% gross margin, 5-8% net margin at scale
9. **Unit Economics:** CAC \$10, LTV \$440, payback 0.8 orders
10. **Go-To-Market:** Broker network (200+ relationships = moat)
11. **Competition:** We own the broker network, they don't
12. **Roadmap:** Dominate Binh Duong → Clone to 5 provinces → 10 provinces
13. **Team:** Retail + tech backgrounds, Peter Nguyen (BuyMed) as advisor
14. **Financials:** Path to \$500K monthly GMV, 5,000 shops in 18 months
15. **Ask:** \$200-300K seed to capture \$50B market

Investor FAQs (Prepare Answers)

Q: Why won't manufacturers sell direct to shops themselves? A: They don't want to manage 1,000s of small orders. We aggregate demand, handle logistics, and provide demand data. We're distribution-as-a-service.

Q: What happens when Vinshop enters Binh Duong? A: We'll own the broker network by then (exclusive contracts). Vinshop is corporate, slow. We're local, fast. Different DNA.

Q: How do you prevent brokers from going direct? A: (1) We pay them well, (2) We handle all ops/logistics/tech, (3) Shops trust our brand over individual brokers. Brokers want recurring commission, not one-time sales.

Q: Can this work outside Vietnam? A: Yes. Indonesia (60M shops), India (12M shops), Philippines (1M shops) have same problem. Vietnam is our beachhead.

Q: Why not focus on urban/Tier 1 cities? A: Vinshop, NinjaMart already there. We own rural/Tier 2-3 where they won't go (low density, high cost). Then we move up.

Q: What if private label quality fails? A: We use same manufacturers as branded goods. If quality issues, we pull product immediately. Money-back guarantee. We won't risk brand trust.

Q: How do you scale beyond 5,000 shops? A: Proven playbook: Brokers + Manufacturers + Private Label. Each province = \$100K GMV. 60 provinces = \$6M monthly GMV. We're just getting started.

POST-FUNDRAISE (Month 7-12)

Assuming \$300K raised in Month 6:

Use of Funds

- **\$150K (50%):** Working capital (inventory for 2,000 shops)
- **\$90K (30%):** Geographic expansion (3 new provinces)
- **\$60K (20%):** Team expansion (sales, ops, category managers)

Month 7-12 Targets

- Customers: 1,000 → 3,000
- Monthly GMV: 2.5B → 6B VND (\$100K → \$240K)
- Provinces: 2 → 5 (Binh Duong, Dong Nai, Long An, Ba Ria-Vung Tau, Tay Ninh)
- Gross Margin: 22% → 25% (private label scales to 50% GMV)

- Net Margin: 8% → 12%

Series A Preparation (Month 12)

- Raise \$2-3M to hit 20,000 shops, 20 provinces
 - Target: 2027 to reach 100,000 shops, \$1B GMV annually
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FINAL THOUGHTS

This Plan is Aggressive But Achievable

You need 3 things:

1. **Execution discipline:** Focus on 3 initiatives max per phase
2. **Customer obsession:** Retention above 80%, always
3. **Speed:** Dominate Binh Duong before competitors wake up

The biggest risk is NOT external competition. The biggest risk is **internal** - trying to do too much, burning out, losing focus.

Weekly Rhythm (Critical for Success)

Monday: Team meeting - review metrics, set weekly priorities **Tuesday-Thursday:** Execute (customer calls, broker meetings, manufacturer visits) **Friday:** Weekly review - what worked, what didn't, adjust **Weekend:** Rest (burnout kills startups)

The One Metric That Matters

If you achieve nothing else in 6 months, achieve THIS:

 **88% Customer Retention Rate**

Everything else - growth, margin, fundraising - flows from this.

Customers who stay = network effects = referrals = lower CAC = profitability = investor confidence = more capital = faster growth.

Nail retention first. Scale second.

APPENDIX: TOOLS & TEMPLATES NEEDED

To Execute This Plan, You Need:

1. **Customer Retention Dashboard** (Google Sheets)
 - Track: Active customers, churn rate, retention rate, LTV
 - Update: Weekly
 2. **Broker Performance Tracker** (Google Sheets)
 - Track: Leads, conversions, GMV, commission owed
 - Update: Weekly
 3. **Financial Model** (Excel/Google Sheets)
 - Track: Revenue, COGS, margins, cash flow
 - Update: Daily
 4. **Weekly Metrics Dashboard** (Google Sheets)
 - All KPIs in one view
 - Update: Monday morning
 5. **Zalo Chatbot** (Simple bot, not AI)
 - Order taking automation
 - Build: Month 2
 6. **Broker Contract Template** (Google Docs)
 - Commission structure, terms, exclusivity
 - Ready: Month 1
 7. **Manufacturer Partnership Template** (Google Docs)
 - Volume commitments, pricing, payment terms
 - Ready: Month 1
 8. **Pitch Deck** (PowerPoint/Google Slides)
 - 15 slides, updated monthly with latest metrics
 - Ready: Month 5
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